a music channel. On comes the new Spice Girls' video, 'Say You'll Be There'. They're dancing in the desert and Posh is wearing this black cat suit and looks like just about the most amazing woman I've ever set eyes on. I'd seen the Spice Girls before—who hadn't—and whenever that blokes' conversation came up about which one do you fancy, I always said:

'The posh one. The one with the bob. The one with the legs.'

But that evening, in that claustrophobic hotel room, it dawned on me for the first time. Posh Spice was fantastic and I had to find a way to be with her. Where was my Lawrence of Arabia outfit? Who was going to lend me a camel?

'She's so beautiful. I just love everything about that girl, Gaz. You know, I've got to meet her.'

Gary probably thought I was getting a bit stir-crazy. We'd been through quite a lot together but that hadn't included me falling in love with a pop star on the television. That's what was going on: right at that moment, my heart was set on Victoria. I had to be with her. How could I make it happen, though? I was a young guy, with a career as a soccer player that was just starting to go quite well. This beautiful, sexy woman who I was desperate to meet was a Spice Girl. At the time, Victoria and the Girls were everywhere: number one in the pop charts, on the cover of every magazine and on the front page of every newspaper, jetting all over the world. They were the biggest thing on the planet. There were pop stars and pop stars. And then there were the Spice Girls. Here was I, deciding I really needed to go out with one of them.

What was I supposed to do? Write to her?

'Dear Posh Spice. You don't know me but I have this very strong feeling that, if we could meet somehow, I think we'd get on really well. I don't know what your schedule's like but you can find me at Old Trafford every other Saturday.'

You hear stories about A-list celebrities who know how to arrange this sort of thing. Not me. I couldn't exactly get My People to speak to Her People. I'm sure I wasn't the only bloke in the world who was carrying a torch for 'The One With The Bob' at the time. It might have sounded crazy, but I was absolutely certain that meeting Posh Spice was something that simply had to happen, even though I didn't have a clue as to how or where. I got my sister Joanne to dig out a copy of *Smash Hits* so I could at least find